

My Path Into Private Worship

I do not know why we thought the devil would spare us. The only time he will spare you is when he is beating you backward into some doctrine that alienates truth and promotes unbelief.

If you do not want to be bothered, go to a church and pay somebody to tell you that you are okay no matter what. If you are afraid of hell, you can find an eternal security church. There is a place for almost anything.

But in Mark 4, Jesus said Satan comes for one reason. The sower sows the Word, and Satan comes immediately to steal the Word. There is no other reason. He knows that if he can take the Word away, it is finished.

He uses cares of this life, deceitfulness of riches, persecution, affliction, and other things, but it is all for the same reason: he wants to remove the Word.

When Jesus was preparing the disciples for His departure, He said, "I will not leave you comfortless." He said He would send the Comforter, and when He came, He would guide them into all truth.

Have you noticed that in religion, the devil fought so hard against any connection with the Holy Spirit that would cause that to come to pass? If he wants to remove the Word, it makes sense that he would also want to remove the authority of the Person of the Godhead who was put in place to guide you into all the truth of it.

Jesus said the Holy Spirit would guide you into all truth. We are teaching you how to turn yourself over to Him.

If God were going to push anybody, it would have been Adam. If He were going to overpower anyone's will and beat him into submission, He would have stopped Adam. But if He did not stop him, what makes you think He will override the thing that cost heaven the most: your right to make choices?

Without that, who would have fellowship? Anything He created would simply be programmed to move for Him. "I want to be loved. Push the button." Then it says, "I love you. I love you. I love you."

That is only a recording.

Your right to make choices cost Him everything. Even to be taught, you must choose. He said the Holy Spirit guides. He does not shove you, push you, or drag you.

People create doctrines that say, "The reason you had that car wreck is that God planned it; otherwise you would not have obeyed Him." No. He did not put you in a car wreck and break you into submission. If that were the case, He would have gotten a great big Cadillac and run over Adam in the garden.

He came to guide us.

God is absolute sovereignty, righteousness, justice, immutability, eternal life, love, omniscience, omnipresence, omnipotence, and truth. These make up the one essence of God. There never was a "before" He was. He came from eternity and is going to eternity.

It amazes me that Someone with that kind of power and existence would value fellowship. Even with the angels, Satan was perfect in his ways until iniquity was found in him. How could he come to a place where he made a choice like that?

Yet God seems to want company that means it when it raises its hands and says, "I love You."

In His immutability, God cannot change nor be changed. One of the best demonstrations of that immutability is the impossibility of lying. By two immutable things, He cannot lie, and He could swear by no greater than Himself.

He cannot lie.

When I understood that, I was locking horns with people who said Jesus was only a prophet. They asked, "Why did God not just forgive Adam? Why not say, 'Adam, I am God. You are forgiven. Let's go on'?"

If such a conversation had happened and you were hiding behind a bush, you might have heard God say, "Adam, why did you not believe what I said? I said you would die."

God cannot lie. Adam had to die. Eve died. They were cut off. God was left with an impossible situation: He could not lie, and the family was dead.

Here is the good side: ten billion years from now, God will not go on a rampage and destroy you, because He cannot change.

When you understand that the Word of God is truth, you understand why the devil comes to steal it. He knows that if you catch on, you will cause a rampage on this planet.

After Adam and Eve fell, God walked through the garden and questioned them. They were hiding because they knew sin. Adam blamed Eve. Eve blamed the serpent. We have heard that before. The first family used it.

Then God judged the serpent. He said the serpent would crawl on its belly and eat dust. That meant Satan was restricted in his power. If you knew the power of that cherub, you would know he could wipe out an army in minutes. But as it stands, he cannot push you off a cliff. All he can do is try to talk you into jumping.

Then God said there would be a Seed born of woman who would inflict a death wound on him. He would bruise the serpent's head, and the serpent would bruise His heel.

God prophesied four thousand years into the future. He prophesied Jesus was coming. Jesus would take Adam's death and die. He would be made sin, not a sinner, so that we might be made the righteousness of God in Him.

After God judged the serpent, He judged Adam and Eve. Creation went haywire. Animals began eating each other. Romans says all creation was subjected to vanity, or corruption, by reason of Him who subjected it in hope. One day there will be total recovery through Jesus Christ, but meanwhile creation labors under imperfection because it is scheduled for termination.

Then it came time to meet Adam and Eve's need. That was when the first sacrifice was offered. Where did God get the skins? This was the first blood shed. He killed animals to clothe Adam and Eve, and that blood reached forward four thousand years to the cross.

Before that, He had nothing to meet their need with.

I look at that and realize I was alive in Adam's DNA. Humanity came from him. Jesus became our sin and death, and He was the first Man innocent in that place whom God could bring back out. Then Jesus, who suffered in our place, turned and gave us His standing by grace.

He did it all in the shadow first: killed the animal, clothed them with skins, and started meeting their needs.

How much does He love me? I know how much He loved Jesus, but how much did He love me?

Do you think it was fellowship for Him to watch murderers, nation wiping out nation, endless animal sacrifices, laws, restrictions, and shadows? He walked tediously through four thousand years, even losing one world, to get me back.

No, He loves you with the love He loved Jesus. That is the only reason you are here.

Noah's ark took one hundred years to build. Why? It was Noah's pulpit for one hundred years. The whole planet had one language. You do not think there were sightseeing tours? God took the only route He could.

He went through all of that to reach the day when you would be born again, become His son or daughter, be filled with the Holy Spirit, let Him become your Teacher, and help Him harvest the rest of the brothers and sisters He paid such a price for.

Something is happening to my faith. Maybe it is because we want revival and have received it.

I would love to see the reaction of this whole town if every child in every hospital were emptied this afternoon. Would the church be full next Sunday?

Has anything like that happened in the Word outside of Jesus doing it? Yes. In the apostles' ministry, they brought them all, and every one was healed in different cases. It has been done before by people who received what Jesus said.

"What if He does not want to?"

He went through all of that for the last six thousand years because He does not want this town saved? Because He does not want to do what He said He would do?

I had to get it down inside: He loves me. He loved me when I was in Adam's DNA. He meticulously went through everything He did because He loves me.

Now I see how foolish some of my past prayers were. I would bring a little list before Him, trying to show Him reasons He should move. Or I would say, "I am one of Your believers. You should heal me because I am useful." Many preachers have found out that does not work.

Then I thought I could talk Him into it by telling Him how much I loved Him.

But after He took me through that journey, I thought, "What is the matter with you, Roberson? Do you think He went through all of that so you could walk into His presence doubting whether He will hear you?"

He did all of that so you could walk into His presence and have Him, especially concerning lost people, disease, and what His Word promises.

At first, I did not walk into condemnation, but whatever was wrong in my body or finances, I knew this: I am in the process of turning.

The thing making that turn in me is the door He unlocked into the love of God. It is what brought me off the old road and what He had me major on to understand.

God cannot love me any more. He maxed His love for me at the cross. There is no use trying to get Him to love me more. But I can stop and find out how to receive more of the love He has always loved me with.

When that begins to happen, it does not go unnoticed. It begins doing a work in your spirit.

After the new birth, Jesus said:

"Ye have heard that it hath been said,
An eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth:
But I say unto you,
Love your enemies,
bless them that curse you,
do good to them that hate you,
and pray for them which despitefully use you."

Under law, spiritually dead people needed law because Cain would keep killing Abel. But when the change came, we received a new nature with unlimited capacity to receive and understand the Word, His instructions, revelation knowledge, and the love of God.

When that love is in manifestation, it is His compassion. Love is the fuel compassion burns.

When Jesus was moved by compassion, He healed them.

Besides the familiar truths that love never fails and casts out fear, what does love begin to build?

If compassion is love in manifestation, then we must receive portions of love in proportion to what manifests outwardly. It has to do with the heart, the place where Jesus said not to doubt.

He said you could say to the mountain, "Be removed and cast into the sea," and not doubt in your heart, and you would have what you say. Then He said, if you have ought against somebody, go fix that and come back.

What would cause a person to forgive? What really happens inside?

I have the capacity to walk in more than I have received. Praying in tongues brought me to that door when God knew I could begin to handle it.

My first doses of love took me straight to questions about hell, fire, and brimstone. When I got my first good look at the love of God, I cried for nine hours straight until my tear ducts dried out. I began loving myself more because I got a glimpse of how much He loved you. I thought, "If He loves them that much, then He has to love me that much too."

But after that first dose began operating in me, I could not understand God and hell. I could not understand what happened to people on the other side of the world who died before the apostles reached them. If I had not continued on the path and kept praying in tongues, I might have gone toward eternal security or all-inclusive salvation.

What saved me?

Praying in tongues.

First, I slipped into worship, and it would bubble out of me when I did not know what I was doing. Then I would be back in tongues, then back in worship: "Hallelujah. I love You. I worship You and glorify You."

That was Him praying His own prayer and answering it by bringing me forward in the love of God.

The passion play in Oklahoma City had Broadway-level production. Angels flew on wires, and everything was done well, but I could not feel a presence equal to the talent. I asked, "What would it take to get Your presence into something like this?"

On the way home, He answered: "If you went home and worshiped Me all night, you would find out."

I fooled around for a year. Then He laid me out on the rug when nobody prayed for me and said, "I already gave you the key. Are you going to open the door or not?"

I said yes.

I returned to worship, dry or not. It got so dry it felt like drinking cracker juice. I kept offering worship words that felt flat on the floor, as if I had to scrape them up with a spatula and throw them toward heaven again.

Through the dry spell I was desperate to find help. I read books on private worship. They said if you are dry, you are not breaking through. But after I came out of it, I had a little vision.

I saw angels rejoicing. They were glad that I stayed in through the "spatula era." They were saying, "Did you see that? Did you see how he stayed in no matter what?"

That is when I found out the major progress I made in private worship and the love of God came when hell tried to stop the light out and did everything it could, but I plowed through it.

According to them, what I did catapulted me forward. It was not failure to break through. It was doing everything right to break through.

I studied recorded history and found that from time to time, after the apostolic era, an anointing of love got loose. It melted sinners out of their chairs. They did not have a chance. Miracles often took place too, but this love was distinct.

I kept worshiping and plowing. When annual fasting time came, I added nothing but pure worship to the fast. I could have prayed in tongues, because whenever you want to respond, He responds. But I did not. I did nothing in that fasting time except worship.

I got visited by another kind of war. It lasted until near the end. Every day I lay in the middle of that bed, over thirty days in, feeling like weights were on my fingers and body. But I knew it was a fight, so I kept pressing.

Then I lifted my hands, and it felt like something picked me up. I came up onto my feet, lifted my hands, and He fell. I began weeping and trying to grasp what was happening. Could I stand under that much love? I did not think so.

Every minute glowed. Life was off the charts.

God knew I wanted to preach. When I went to my first meetings after that, the power in the services was stronger. But what shocked me was what happened after the meetings.

The pastor's mother came into the back room. Her thumb would not bend. She asked me to pray. I was tired but full of that love. I reached to see how far it would move, and it bent. She said, "My God, it has never done that before. It is healed."

Then a boy came in, maybe sixteen or seventeen, blind in one eye. I put my hand over his eye and prayed in Jesus' name. When I took it off and said, "Look at me," he looked and said, "Oh my God, I can see!" Then he ran into the yard yelling, "I can see!"

I had seen gifts operate in services before. But this was after church, when I was worn out. I knew it was connected with more love.

When I asked what kind of anointing waited until after the service, He showed me this: it was the anointing of the believer.

"These signs shall follow them that believe;
In my name shall they cast out devils;
they shall speak with new tongues;
they shall lay hands on the sick,
and they shall recover."

That is the believer's anointing.

The body of Christ has gifts distributed: to one the working of miracles, to another gifts of healings, to another other gifts. Those may major in a ministry when someone goes out and preaches. I had that equipping along with the calling.

But the believer's anointing will follow you to a hospital. It will follow you to somebody's house. Why? Because it is based on the grace He loved you with, and you finally stopped to receive more of what He has always loved you with since He maxed it at the cross.

Now He is letting me go back. What have I learned? He established me and is continuing to move me forward in the love He loved you with when He stood in the garden and did everything imaginable to save you.

No devil and no army can tell me He does not love me.

The maimed, the lame, the deaf, the mute, the blind, they can all be healed. The devil has threatened me, tried everything, and told me he would kill me. He really did not want me to finish the love key.

If my own child could not hear, see, or talk, and I heard about someone who went into a hospital and saw children healed instantly, you could not keep me away from that meeting. That is what the devil is stopping.

Do not be hard on yourself. He has been very successful in history. You would be the exception.

Remember this: you can pray in tongues while you read the Word.

I take the New Testament, count the pages from Matthew to the end, and divide by thirty. That gives me the number of pages to read every day to read the whole New Testament each month. In my giant-print Bible, it is about fourteen pages a day.

You can pray in tongues while reading. If you have to go back and reread a verse, do it. It will not hurt you. Just do not stop praying.

Then take time to suspend your spirit in the presence of worship, praising and glorifying your Father for loving you. Hallelujah is a good word. I drift into, "Hallelujah, hallelujah. I praise You, magnify You, and worship You."

When this love began moving in the camp meetings, people broke down sobbing, crying, falling out of chairs, and screaming. That carried through Brazil. Even with a translator, a crowd, and a language barrier, the Holy Ghost did not care. The same compassion saturated the crowd. They wept like children.

If you want to journey through this next phase of the prayer center, continue praying in tongues and assimilating the Word. But start by adding an hour of breaking into worship.

I would not let myself pray in tongues during those worship times because I wanted to find out what He wanted me to do and how worship worked. That is why it got so dry when I could not break out into tongues on the side.

You cannot suspend your spirit in His presence and hold it there for any length of time without being affected by His love.